

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1648

By Salinas

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend the musical *Suffs* and its performances at the Orpheum Theater in Memphis.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should honor those artistic works that illuminate significant chapters of American history and contribute to the civic and cultural life of this State; and

WHEREAS, *Suffs* is a Tony Award-winning musical with the music, lyrics, and book by Shaina Taub, based on the suffragists of the American women's suffrage movement and focusing on the events leading up to the ratification of the Nineteenth Amendment to the United States Constitution, which afforded women the right to vote; and

WHEREAS, the musical *Suffs* brings to life the stories of the women who fought for voting rights, exploring the strategic differences and shared goals of key figures such as Alice Paul, Carrie Chapman Catt, Ida B. Wells, Lucy Burns, Inez Milholland, Doris Stevens, and Mary Church Terrell as they organized marches, protests, and advocacy campaigns in pursuit of equal suffrage; and

WHEREAS, *Suffs* traces pivotal moments in the suffrage movement, from the 1913 march on Washington, through which suffragists directly challenged national leaders to support a federal amendment, to the internal debates and tensions within the movement regarding tactics and inclusion, giving voice to both celebrated and historically overlooked activists; and

WHEREAS, Tennessee holds a distinguished place in the history of women's suffrage, as the deciding vote cast in the Tennessee General Assembly in 1920 was crucial to the ratification of the Nineteenth Amendment, helping to secure enfranchisement for women nationwide; and

WHEREAS, the Orpheum Theater in Memphis will host *Suffs* from July 28 through August 2, 2026, offering Tennessee audiences the opportunity to experience this compelling portrayal of civic engagement, democratic ideals, and the collective struggle for equality; and

WHEREAS, *Suffs* premiered off-Broadway in 2022 and opened on Broadway in 2024, earning critical acclaim as a bold and inspiring theatrical work that educates, moves, and entertains through its rich score and dramatic storytelling; and

WHEREAS, through its vivid depiction of historical figures and events, including Ida B. Wells, who lived in Memphis and covered the front lines of racial injustice, *Suffs* highlights the perseverance, courage, and complexity of the women who advanced the cause of suffrage and underscores the importance of civic participation, social justice, and shared democratic values; and

WHEREAS, we are pleased to welcome *Suffs* to Tennessee and to applaud its presentation at the Orpheum Theater in Memphis; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend the musical *Suffs* and its performances at the Orpheum Theater in Memphis, celebrating its artistic excellence and its powerful portrayal of an essential chapter in American history.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.